Prompt & Suggestion Data Retention Across Copilot Plans

Question: A Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) at a regulated financial institution is evaluating **GitHub Copilot Business** and asks whether proprietary source code sent inside IDE inline completion prompts or Copilot Chat sessions is stored on GitHub's servers or used to train future foundation models. Which statement accurately describes GitHub's data-handling commitment for Copilot Business and Enterprise?

A. Prompts and suggestions are retained for 90 days for security auditing unless the organization enables a paid Zero-Retention add-on.

B. Prompts and suggestions for inline completions and IDE Chat are not retained after the suggestion is generated, and customer data is never used to train foundation models. **[CORRECT ANSWER]**

C. All enterprise code snippets are pooled into a shared cross-tenant cache to accelerate completions for other enterprise customers.

D. Telemetry and prompt payloads are stored indefinitely in the organization's GitHub Audit Log.

Explanation & Exam Rationale

Under **GitHub Copilot Business** and **GitHub Copilot Enterprise**, prompts (code context before/after the cursor and Chat messages) and generated suggestions are transmitted over TLS strictly to compute the real-time response and are **discarded immediately** once the response is returned (zero-retention for IDE completions and Chat). GitHub does not use Business or Enterprise prompts, suggestions, or private repository code to train base foundation models.

Copilot Tier	Prompts & Suggestions Retention	Used to Train Base Models?
Copilot Business / Enterprise	Not retained (ephemeral processing in memory for IDE completions & Chat)	**Never** (strict contractual privacy guarantee)
Copilot Individual / Pro	Retained only if user opts in to sharing code snippets for product improvement	Only if the individual user explicitly opts in via account settings
User Engagement Data (All Plans)	Aggregated metadata (acceptances, dismissals, latency, error codes)	Used for service health & telemetry; contains no proprietary source code

Key Exam Takeaway: Distinguish between **Prompts & Suggestions** (code snippets—never retained or trained on in Business/Enterprise) and **User Engagement Data** (pseudonymized interaction telemetry like acceptance counts and latency).